

OUTER SKELETONS

Several groups of invertebrates have an armour-like external skeleton. The rigid casing protects inner organs from damage and possibly from predators. When insects or creatures such as crabs grow, they shed their exoskeleton and make a new one.



TARANTULA



CRAB



LOBSTER



MILLIPEDE



RHINOCEROS BEETLE



DRAGONFLY



MEALWORM LARVA

ECHINODERM SKELETON

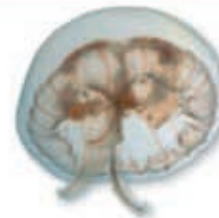
Echinoderms include marine invertebrates like sea urchins and starfish. They have an exoskeleton made of plates, covered by a thin layer of skin. When these animals grow, their skeleton grows with them.



SEA URCHIN

HYDROSTATIC SKELETON

The shape of many soft-bodied invertebrates is supported by a water-based "skeleton" consisting of a fluid-filled cavity surrounded by a muscular wall.



JELLYFISH



AN ELEPHANT'S SKELETON IS THE HEAVIEST OF ALL THE LAND MAMMALS



BAT



SQUIRREL



HARE



BADGER



GORILLA



CHIMPANZEE



HUMAN



CAT



MONKEY



WOLF



HORSE



TIGER